



BARSTOW COMMUNITY COLLEGE · FACULTY

Course materials reporting

Why the adoption form matters, what counts as a required material, and why zero cost does not mean no materials.

Angela Cardinale

Associate Dean, Library and Learning Support

September 1, 2026

THE LAW

This is a disclosure requirement, not a preference

Colleges must “prominently display ... the estimated costs for each course of all required course materials and fees directly related to those materials.”

Education Code § 66406.9, as amended by AB 607 (2023)

Federal law already required the ISBN and retail price of required and recommended textbooks, plus the cost of supplemental materials, to be disclosed in the course schedule at the time of registration.

THE DEADLINES ARE ESCALATING

Percentage of sections that must publish costs

40%

by Jan 1, 2025

55%

by Jan 1, 2026

65%

by Jan 1, 2027

75%

by Jan 1, 2028

The Chancellor's Office surveys colleges to certify compliance. The denominator is every section on the online schedule with an assigned instructor.

WHERE WE ARE

Building the picture, then getting it in front of students

We are collecting more accurate and more complete course materials information than we have before. **312 of 454 sections** now have an adoption on file for Fall 2026.

The next step is publishing it on the class schedule, so the cost information reaches students at the point where it helps them, which is when they register. We are working on that now.

What we need from you is the first half: complete, detailed, timely entries for every section.

FALL 2026, AS OF AUGUST 31

THE MOST COMMON MISTAKE

Zero cost does not mean no materials

Common issues

- The book is free, so nothing gets reported
- “No required materials” chosen because nothing is purchased
- “This course uses OER” with no title, author, or link
- No ISBN and no edition, which leaves nothing to verify the price against
- Access codes, lab kits, and software left off

What the form needs

- An OER course **has** required materials. They are free, not absent.
- Every item listed separately, required ones marked required
- Title, author, edition, ISBN, and link
- Your best estimate of the cost. Not knowing the exact price is not a reason to leave it blank, we verify with eCampus.
- Enough detail that a student could find and buy it from your entry alone

NOT ENOUGH Biology textbook — free online

ENOUGH **Biology 2e**, OpenStax, 2nd edition, ISBN 9781947172517, openstax.org, \$0. Required. Also required: lab manual, \$18.

THE XB12 CODES

Seven answers, and five of them are zero cost

CODE	WHAT IT MEANS	CATEGORY	FALL 2026
A	No required materials at all	ZERO COST	79
C	Materials provided by the college	ZERO COST	10
E	OER only	ZERO COST	64
F	Free digital, not formally OER	ZERO COST	21
G	Mix of OER and college-provided	ZERO COST	27
D	Students pay \$40 or less	LOW COST	26
Y	Students pay more than \$40	STANDARD	94

A AND E ARE NOT THE SAME ANSWER. CHOOSING A FOR AN OER COURSE LOSES THE OER COUNT.

ALL REQUIRED MATERIALS

It is not only the textbook

AB 607 requires disclosure of all instructional materials associated with a course. The Chancellor's Office names these explicitly:

01	02	03	04	05
Textbooks	Devices	Software subscriptions	Supplies	Related fees
Digital or physical.	Calculators, and remote attendance platforms.	Including access codes bundled with a text.	Lab kits, safety goggles, art materials, scrubs, tools, anything a student must buy.	Fees directly tied to those materials.

A free textbook paired with a \$60 access code is not a zero-cost course. If anything still costs money, the section is not ZTC.

ALSO ON YOU

Cost minimization is a stated duty

District policies “shall direct instructors to take reasonable steps to minimize the cost and ensure the necessity of instructional materials.”

Title 5, California Code of Regulations, § 59404(a)

Separately, an instructor who requires materials they authored, or from which they receive royalties, must disclose that to the institution.

WHAT TO DO

Report every section, in full, on time

01

Every section

Including the ones with free materials and the ones with none.

02

Every item

Access codes, software, devices, lab supplies.

03

Your best estimate

Estimate the cost. We verify prices with eCampus.

04

Before registration

The disclosure only helps if it is there when students enroll.

QUESTIONS: LIBRARY@BARSTOW.EDU

COME WITH QUESTIONS

Training session

Tuesday, September 9

2:00 to 3:00 pm

with Kyri Freeman

A session on finding and adopting course materials, with a focus on open educational resources.

BRING QUESTIONS ABOUT A COURSE YOU ARE WORKING ON